



Report on
**Professional Certificate in Procurement &
Contract Management**
*Joint Initiative of COMSATS University Islamabad (CUI) and Public
Procurement Regulatory Authority (PPRA)*

August 31 - September 04, 2026

COMSATS UNIVERSITY ISLAMABAD
Faculty Development Academy

Executive Summary

The Professional Certificate in Procurement & Contract Management was jointly organized by COMSATS University Islamabad (CUI) and the Public Procurement Regulatory Authority (PPRA) from August 31 to September 4, 2026, under the MoU between the two institutions. The five-day capacity-building program was designed to strengthen professional competencies in public procurement, regulatory compliance, contract management, and digital procurement practices.

A total of 35 participants from a diverse range of public and private sector organizations attended. The program comprised 24 contact hours across 15 structured sessions. Expert trainers and subject matter experts provided practical and technical insights through lectures, case studies, group discussions, practical exercises, and demonstrations.

The curriculum covered the complete procurement and contract management cycle, including the PPRA regulatory framework, strategic procurement planning, needs assessment, make-or-buy decisions, Standard Bidding Documents (SBDs), evaluation criteria, risk management, Incoterms, consultancy services, supplier management, asset disposal, contract management, and contract closure. A key feature of the program was the hands-on demonstration of e-PADS 2.0, enabling participants to develop a practical understanding of digital procurement processes and tender execution.

Participants' feedback was highly positive, particularly regarding the quality of instruction, practical relevance of the sessions, and applicability of the knowledge gained to their professional responsibilities. Overall, the program contributed to enhancing participants' understanding of transparent, efficient, accountable, and compliant procurement practices. The event concluded with a formal certificate distribution ceremony recognizing successful completion of the coursework by all attendees.

Acknowledgements

The Faculty Development Academy (FDA), COMSATS University Islamabad (CUI), is deeply grateful to the worthy Rector, COMSATS University Islamabad, for his generous support, guidance, and vision in facilitating the organization of this PPRA capacity-building program. His encouragement and initiative provided the foundation for FDA to successfully undertake and deliver this important training program.

FDA served as the lead administrator for the training program, overseeing its overall planning, coordination, logistics, and administrative arrangements. Sincere appreciation is expressed to the Public Procurement Regulatory Authority (PPRA) for its valuable support in providing the training schedule, highly qualified trainers, and subject matter experts. Their technical expertise, practical experience, and dedicated engagement significantly enriched the learning experience and contributed to the program's overall success.

Special thanks are extended to the FDA administrative team for their seamless coordination and support throughout the program, as well as to all participants for their active engagement, constructive participation, and valuable feedback, which contributed to the overall impact and success of the training.

Professional Certificate in Procurement & Contract Management

Joint Initiative of COMSATS University Islamabad (CUI) and Public Procurement Regulatory Authority (PPRA)

August 31 - September 04, 2026

Background

The Public Procurement Regulatory Authority (PPRA), established under the PPRA Ordinance, 2002, promotes transparency, accountability, and efficiency in public procurement across federal government organizations. As part of its capacity-building mandate, PPRA provides practical training on procurement rules, compliance, risk management, and the e-Pak Acquisition & Disposal System (e-PADS).

In line with this vision, PPRA signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with COMSATS University Islamabad (CUI) to jointly deliver structured training programs to enhance procurement capacity and promote transparent, efficient, and effective public procurement in Pakistan.

On August 31, 2026, COMSATS University Islamabad (CUI) and the Public Procurement Regulatory Authority (PPRA) launched a collaborative intensive training initiative titled the "Professional Certificate in Procurement and Contract Management". The training was held from August 31 to September 4, 2026, at Junaid Zaidi Library, COMSATS University, Islamabad. The primary objective of the program was to equip professionals with practical knowledge and essential skills in procurement frameworks, legal and regulatory compliance, contract management, and modern digital tools, including E-PADS 2.0, with a focus on promoting transparency, efficiency, and accountability. A total of 35 participants representing a diverse range of public and private sector organizations attended the training.

Program Objectives

The training program aimed to:

- Develop a strong understanding of public procurement principles, legal frameworks, and regulatory requirements.
- Enhance participants' knowledge of key procurement processes, including procurement planning, selection methods, tendering, and end-to-end procurement lifecycle management.

- Strengthen practical skills for the effective, transparent, and compliant administration of contracts.
- Build participants' confidence in using E-PADS 2.0 to promote transparency, efficiency, and accountability in procurement processes.
- Provide opportunities for professional networking and experience sharing among participants from diverse public and private sector organizations.

Training Methodology

The intensive five-day training program comprised 24 contact hours over 17 structured sessions. The program adopted an interactive and practical methodology, combining lectures, case studies, group discussions, and hands-on exercises, with trainers from PPRA and external experts facilitating the sessions.



Particular emphasis was placed on practical application through live demonstrations and exercises on E-PADS 2.0, enabling participants to gain firsthand experience of digital procurement workflows. The curriculum covered key areas of public procurement and contract management, including Standard Bidding Documents (SBDs), Incoterms, consultancy services, PPRA regulations, asset disposal, E-PADS 2.0, and contract management.

Training Contents

Day 1

- **Session 1.1: Opening Session** – The In-charge FDA formally inaugurated the session and welcomed the participants. The keynote address by a representative of PPRA, Mr. Atique Sultan Raja, Senior Specialist, highlighted the importance of standardized, transparent, and efficient procurement practices and emphasized the role of digital governance platforms in strengthening procurement processes. Later, Dr Faheem Ashraf Qureshi, Registrar CUI, reaffirmed the university's commitment to promoting institutional development, good governance, and professional capacity building across national organizations.
- **Session 1.2: Workshop Overview** – The trainers introduced the objectives, structure, methodology, and expected learning outcomes of the five-day program. Participants were briefed on the key topics, practical activities, and interactive learning approaches to be followed throughout the training.
- **Session 1.3: Strategic Procurement Planning & Needs Assessment** – The session focused on systematic procurement planning, needs assessment, risk identification, and sustainable procurement practices. Participants explored how procurement requirements can be aligned with organizational priorities, available resources, and strategic objectives.
- **Session 1.4: Make vs. Buy vs. Outsource Decisions** – Participants were introduced to decision-making frameworks for determining whether goods or services should be produced internally, procured externally, or outsourced. The session emphasized cost-effectiveness, efficiency, organizational capacity, risks, and optimal resource allocation.
- **Session 1.5: Customization of SBDs (Goods & Services)** – The session provided practical guidance on customizing Standard Bidding Documents (SBDs) to suit specific procurement requirements for goods and services. Participants examined the development of appropriate specifications, evaluation criteria, and contractual provisions while maintaining fairness and compliance.

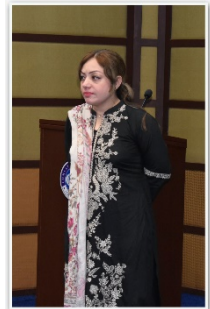
Day 2



•**Session 2.1: Foundations of SBDs for Works** – The session introduced different types of works contracts, pre-qualification procedures, bidding requirements, and bid evaluation methods. Participants gained an understanding of how to structure procurement processes for works while ensuring fairness, competition, and compliance with applicable rules.

•**Session 2.2: Customization of Works & Consultancy SBDs** – Participants learned how to customize Standard Bidding Documents (SBDs)

according to the specific requirements of works and consultancy assignments. The session covered the preparation of Terms of Reference (ToRs), technical requirements, evaluation criteria, and contractual provisions.



- **Session 2.3: Risk Management in Procurement** – Through practical cases and interactive discussions, participants explored the identification, assessment, and prioritization of procurement risks. The session focused on developing appropriate risk mitigation measures to minimize delays, cost overruns, non-compliance, and other procurement-related challenges.

Day 3

- **Session 3.1: Incoterms** – The session provided an overview of international commercial terms (Incoterms) and their relevance to the procurement and delivery of goods. Participants examined the allocation of costs, responsibilities, risks, insurance, transportation, and delivery obligations between buyers and sellers.



•**Session 3.2: Consultancy Services Procurement** –

Participants explored the key stages of consultancy procurement, including selection methods, preparation of requests for proposals, and evaluation of technical and financial proposals. A practical case study highlighted the roles and responsibilities of evaluation committees and key decision-making considerations.

•**Session 3.3: PPRA Regulations Overview** – The session provided a comprehensive review of the PPRA regulatory framework, procurement rules, procedures, and compliance requirements. Participants discussed key provisions and their practical application to ensure transparent, competitive, accountable, and legally compliant procurement.

Day 4

- **Session 4.1: Introduction to E-PADS 2.0** – The session introduced participants to the key features and modules of E-PADS 2.0, with practical demonstrations of digital procurement workflows. Participants gained hands-on exposure to procurement planning, petty procurement, Requests for Quotations (RFQs), and supplier management.
- **Session 4.2: Disposal of Public Assets** – Participants were introduced to the procedures and digital workflows involved in the transparent and accountable disposal of public assets through E-PADS 2.0. The practical exercises demonstrated how technology can support proper documentation, approvals, tracking, and compliance throughout the disposal process.
- **Session 4.3: Tender Execution Demonstration** – The session provided a practical demonstration of the single-stage two-envelope procurement method, covering the key steps from tender initiation through evaluation. Participants observed the digital execution of the process and gained practical insights into maintaining confidentiality, transparency, and procedural compliance.



Day 5

- **Session 5.1: Contract Management Fundamentals** – The session introduced the fundamental principles of effective contract administration, with emphasis on managing scope, time, cost, quality, and performance. Participants explored practical approaches for monitoring contractual obligations and ensuring successful delivery of contracted goods, works, and services.
- **Session 5.2: Pre & Post-Award Phases** – Participants examined key activities before and after contract award, including financial management, performance monitoring, risk mitigation, and contract administration. The session also addressed approaches to managing contractual challenges and resolving disputes while protecting organizational interests.
- **Session 5.3: Contract Closure** – The session highlighted the key requirements for effective and compliant contract closure, including completion documentation, final payments, performance verification, and record management. Emphasis was placed on maintaining transparency and capturing lessons learned to improve future procurement and contract management practices.

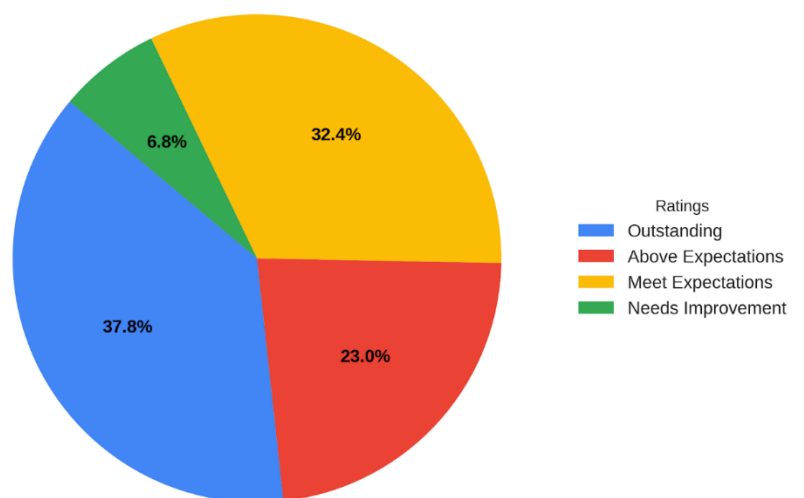


- **Session 5.4: Case Study & Group Discussion** – Participants consolidated their learning through practical case studies, group exercises, and interactive discussions based on real-world procurement and contract management scenarios. The activity encouraged peer learning, experience sharing, and application of the concepts covered throughout the five-day program.
- **Closing Ceremony** – The program concluded with a formal closing ceremony attended by representatives of CUI and PPRA, recognizing the successful completion of the training. Certificates were jointly awarded to participants, marking the culmination of their professional learning and practical engagement in procurement and contract management.



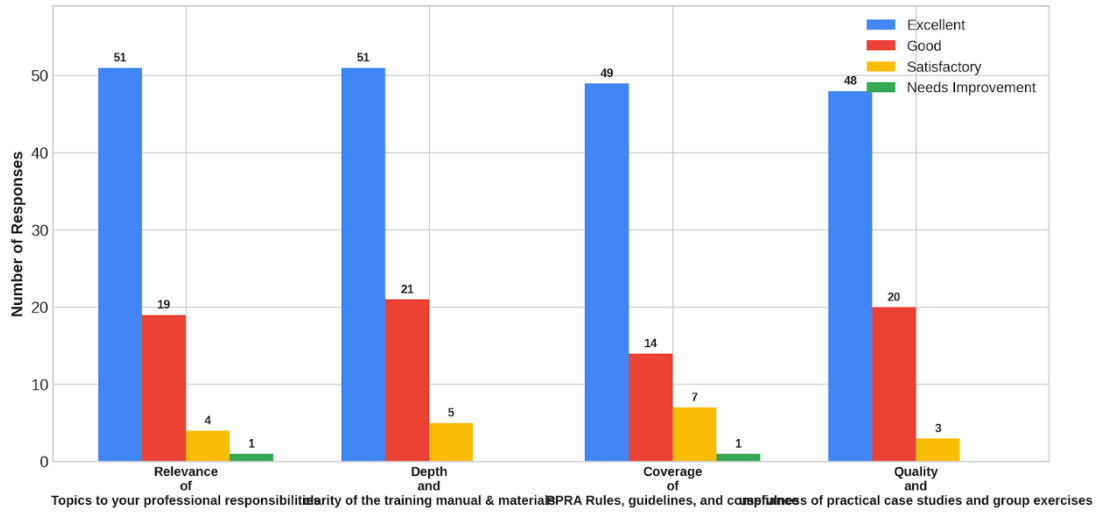
Participants' Feedback

Across the five days, participants found the training content highly relevant and well aligned with their professional roles, with strong appreciation for the coverage of PPRA rules, compliance guidelines, and practical case studies. Trainers were consistently praised for their expertise and clarity, though some suggested shorter lectures and more interactive discussions. The venue and coordination were well received. Suggestions included offering online options during emergencies and tailoring strategic planning sessions for senior leadership. Overall, the program was described as insightful and impactful, with most participants rating it “Outstanding” or “Above Expectations.”

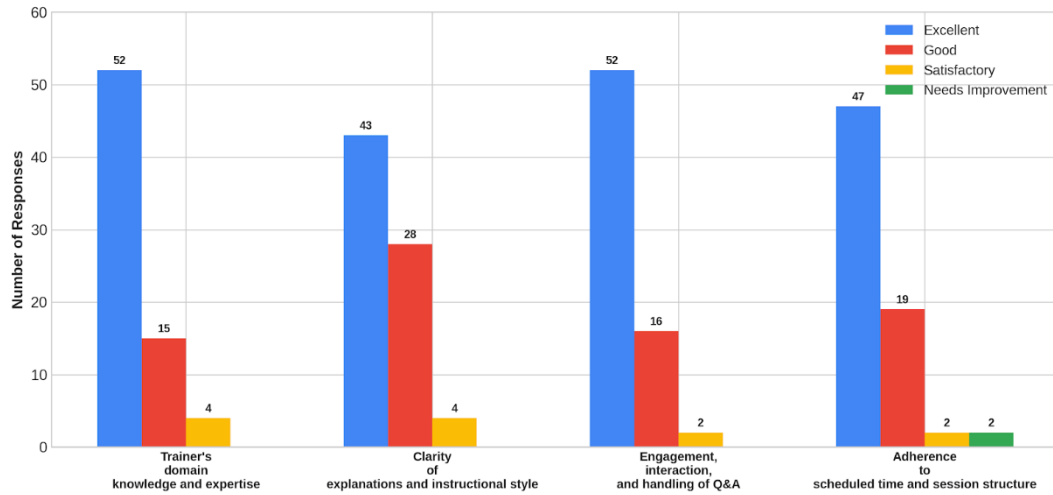


Overall Program Rating

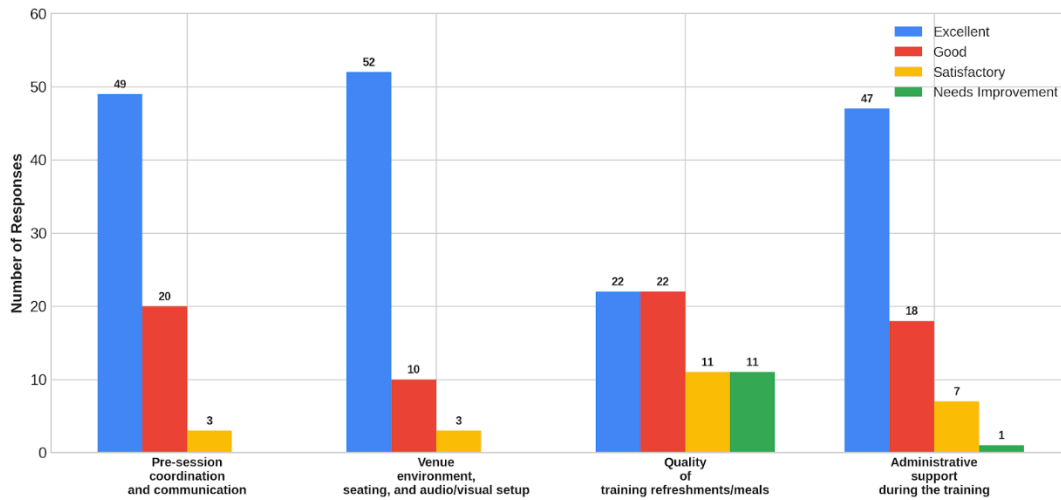
1. COURSE CONTENT & RELEVANCE (Consolidated)



2. FACILITATION & DELIVERY (Consolidated)



3. TRAINING LOGISTICS & ADMINISTRATION (Consolidated)



Opportunities

- **Digital Transformation:** Strong interest in e-PADS 2.0 highlights scope for advanced modules and continuous digital learning support.
- **Leadership Development:** Participants suggested specialized sessions for senior management to strengthen strategic procurement thinking.

Challenges

- **Cross-Jurisdictional Clarity:** Provincial participants noted confusion between federal and provincial PPRA regulations, requiring clearer differentiation in future sessions.

Conclusion

The Professional Certificate in Procurement & Contract Management successfully achieved its objectives of strengthening participants' knowledge, skills, and compliance in public procurement. By combining regulatory expertise with academic rigor, the program bridged theory and practice, enhanced operational competencies, and promoted transparency and accountability. The strong participant feedback underscores the value of continued collaboration between PPRA and COMSATS University Islamabad, with future opportunities to expand training outreach, integrate advanced digital modules, and tailor sessions for leadership development.



TRAINING PROGRAM

Aug 31, 2026 – Day 1

Time	Topic	Resource Person
09:15	Registration: Video Conference Room, Junaid Zaidi Library, COMSATS University Islamabad	
09:30	Group Photograph, Opening Session and Overview of PPRA	Managing Director PPRA
11:00	Tea Break	
11:30	Strategic Procurement Planning & Needs Assessment	Mr. Farrukh Bashir (PPRA)
13:00	Lunch & Prayers Break	
14:00	Make VS. Buy VS. Outsource Framework & Decision-Making	Mr. Farrukh Bashir (PPRA)
15:30	Customization of SBDs and Evaluation Criteria for Goods & Non- Consultancy	Mr. M. Ibrahim R. Khan (PPRA)

Sept 1, 2026 – Day 2

09:30	Foundations of SBDs for Procurement of Works	Dr. M. Aslam Waseem (PPRA)
11:00	Tea Break	
11:30	Customization of Works and Consultancy Services SBDs	Syed Jahangir Rizvi (PPRA)
13:00	Lunch & Prayers Break	
14:00	Implementation, Risk Management and Practical Application of SBDs	Dr. Faiza Nayyer (PPRA)

Sept 2, 2026 – Day 3

09:30	Incoterms	Syed Jahangir Rizvi (PPRA)
11:00	Tea Break	
11:30	Case Study on Consultancy Services	Mr. Atique Sultan Raja (PPRA)
13:00	Lunch & Prayers Break	
14:00	Overview of PPRA Regulations	Dr. Asim Jaleel (PPRA)

Sept 3, 2026 – Day 4

09:30	Introduction to e- PADS, Planning, Petty, RFQ, Supplier Management	Mr. Sagheer Ahmed (PPRA)
11:00	Tea Break	
11:30	Disposal of Public Assets Module	Mr. Sagheer Ahmed (PPRA)
13:00	Lunch & Prayers Break	
14:00	Demonstration of Tender Execution Single stage two envelop	Mr. M. Aasim Bashir (PPRA)

Sept 4, 2026 – Day 5

Contract Management		
0930	Foundations & Legal Framework of Contract Management	Mr. Azmat Ali (External Trainer)
1100	Tea Break	
1130	• Pre & Post-Award Phase & Contract Administration • Financial Management of Contracts • Risk, Performance & Dispute Resolution	Mr. Azmat Ali (External Trainer)
1300	Lunch & Prayers Break	
1400	• Contract Closure & Lessons Learned • Transparency, Documentation and Record Management	Mr. Azmat Ali (External Trainer)
1530	Practical Exercise / Case Study / Group Discussion	
1700	Closing Ceremony	